

'The Cowrte generallye Conceyues this to be a verye heynous offence (1), againste god & his seruyce: for the booke of common prayer that ys now vsed in o^r Church, & hathe bene 45 yeares paste, his Ma^{tie} hathe hearde & bene presente at & allowed & lyked of the same; & is all the worde of god yt selfe, or warranted & grounded vpon the same, & selected & chosen oute of there popishe praiers as the gowld, & leauinge to them the drosse & poyson as superfluous superstitions or incerteine.

Book of
Common
Prayer
warranted
as the word
of God by
Parliament

'(2). againste the dignitie of o^r late soueraigne Queene, in praise of whome all spake exceedinge muche as in deede none Coulede speake inoughe: For Carewe pretended her religion temporarie & politike & by her alone establyshed, whereas all the worlde dothe knowe, that in regarde of her religion onelye god did fighte for her, & blesse her wth peace, plentie & prosperitie; & the booke of Common Prayer was establyshed by the whole state of the kingdome in parliament, & last of all assented vnto & Confirmed by her Ma^{tie}: & the secretarye & Lo. Keper did affyrme that his Ma^{tie} had sayde that anye scandalle or infamous defamacion or suggestion againste o^r late soueraigne Queene he woulde haue as seuerely punished, & shoulde be as odious vnto him as anye offence againste his owne person.

[p. 126]
Commenda-
tion of Queen
Elizabeth

The King
will punish
defamers of
Queen
Elizabeth

'(3). againste the Kinge's Ma^{tie} & his booke (w^{ch} Mr Secretarie called the mirror of vertue),¹ whoe hathe allowed & Confyrmed o^r booke of Common prayer, & no woorde againste it in his booke: for, as the Lo. Keper sayd, albeit there be a Chaunge of the gouernor, yet there ys no Chaunge neither of gouernemente nor in gouernemente.

The King's
book called
the mirror
of vertue

The
gouernor
changes,
not the
government

'(4). againste the state in regarde of the time beinge seditious & stirringe the people: for in all actions the time, place & person are the most necessarye Circumstaunces to be Consydered. For the kinge's ma^{tie}, in his lawfull, iuste & lineall title to the Crowne of Englaunde, comes not by succession onelye, or by election, but from god onelye, (so that there is no *interregnum*, as the igno-

Time, place
and person,
most con-
siderable in
all actions.

[p. 126]

No *inter-
regnum*
when it is by
descent

¹ It seems doubtful which book is here referred to, *Basilikon Doron*, published 1599, or *The True Law of Free Monarchies*, published 1598.